INC-2026-06-30: Edge service that authorises card payments against upstream degradation

Northwind Payments · SEV2 · service payment-gateway · author t.lindqvist

Started 2026-06-30T13:00:00Z · detected 2026-06-30T13:03:00Z · resolved 2026-06-30T13:42:00Z

Customer impact

Authorisations routed to one acquirer failed for 26 minutes, roughly 8% of total volume. Traffic was manually rerouted to a secondary acquirer.

Root cause

A TLS certificate for one acquirer endpoint expired. The renewal automation covered only endpoints registered before January 2026.

Causing change

This incident was caused by release pay-gw-4.6.0, deployed to payment-gateway. The release is recorded in the change log.

Affected services

payment-gateway, checkout-api, merchant-portal. Downstream services were affected through their dependency on payment-gateway.

Timeline (UTC)

13:00 — Release pay-gw-4.6.0 completed rollout earlier in the day.

13:00 — First symptoms observed on payment-gateway.

13:03 — Alert pages the on-call engineer for payment-gateway.

13:33 — Cause identified and mitigation begins.

13:42 — Service returns to baseline; incident resolved.

Action items

• Add an integration test covering the failure mode.

• Document the mitigation steps in the service runbook.

• Require a load test for configuration changes of this class.